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CENTRAL CIVIL SERVICES (LEAVE TRAVEL CONCESSION) RULES, 1988

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For LDCE IP / PS Group B Departmental Examinations

DISCLAIMER: *This booklet has been prepared strictly from an examination point of view. Every provision has been re-verified against the latest in-force Rules, DoP&T Office Memoranda and Department of Expenditure orders (as listed in the Verification Note overleaf). This document is intended as a study aid only. Readers are strongly recommended to refer to official Government sources and gazettes for the most authoritative information.*

Verification & Updation Note

All statutory positions in this booklet have been checked against the latest in-force instructions. The principal instruments relied upon, with dates, are tabulated below so that currency can be independently judged.

Instrument	Date	Subject
CCS (LTC) Rules, 1988	21.05.1988	Parent rules (as amended)
MoF (DoE) OM No. 19030/1/2017-E.IV	13.07.2017	7th CPC travel entitlements (w.e.f. 01.07.2017)
DoP&T OM No. 31011/8/2017-Estt.A-IV	19.09.2017	7th CPC entitlements applied to LTC; premium trains, flexi fare, tatkal
DoP&T OM No. 31011/12/2022-Estt.A-IV	29.08.2022	Booking of air tickets through Authorised Travel Agents (ATAs)
DoP&T OMs dt. 10.08.2023 & 20.10.2023	2023	Modifications: 21-day booking, cancellation, fare-band, e-mail registration
DoP&T OM F.No. 31011/18/2023-Estt.(A-IV)	21.12.2023	Delegation of powers — relaxation of claim time limits
DoE / DoPT clarifications on DA @ 50%	01.01.2024	TA / road-mileage rates enhanced by 25% w.e.f. 01.01.2024
DoP&T OM No. 31011/15/2022-Estt.A-IV	17.09.2024	Special Dispensation Scheme (NER/J&K/Ladakh/A&N) extended to 25.09.2026
DoP&T OM No. 31011/3/2022-PP.A-IV	14.01.2025	Tejas Express, Vande Bharat Express & Humsafar Express allowed on LTC
DoP&T OM F.No. 31011/07/2025-PP.A-IV	01.07.2025	Comprehensive FAQs — clarifications/modifications in LTC instructions
DoP&T OM — Guidelines on LTC	03.09.2025	Consolidated guidelines on LTC (supersedes guidelines dt. 30.04.2024)

Rule 1 — Short Title, Commencement and Application

(1) These rules may be called the Central Civil Services (Leave Travel Concession) Rules, **1988**.

(2) They came into force on the date of their publication in the Official Gazette, i.e. **21st May 1988**.

(3) These rules apply to Government servants —

- who are appointed to civil services and posts, including civilian Government servants in the Defence Services, in connection with the affairs of the Union;
- who are employed under a State Government and are on deputation with the Central Government;
- who are appointed on contract basis; and
- who are re-employed after their retirement.

(4) These rules do NOT apply to —

- Government servants not in whole-time employment;
- persons in casual and daily-rated employment;
- persons paid from contingencies;
- **Railway servants;**
- **members of the Armed Forces;**
- local recruits in Indian Missions abroad; and
- persons eligible to any other form of travel concession available during leave or otherwise.

Government Decisions

- Employees (and spouses of employees) of the Indian Railways and national airlines continue to be debarred from the LTC facility, as they are entitled to the "Free Pass" facility.
- An Indian Railway employee is allowed to avail **All India LTC once in a block of four years** after surrendering the privilege passes for that year. **No Home Town LTC** and no conversion of Home Town LTC is admissible to Railway employees.
- If both spouses are Railway employees, they can avail All India LTC after surrender of privilege passes.

- A Government employee whose spouse works in the Railways may avail **All India LTC** (independently or with family members), subject to surrender of the privilege passes for that year.

Rule 2 — Special Provisions for Certain Categories

(1) The LTC is admissible on completion of **one year's continuous service** under the Central Government.

(2) In the case of (a) State Government employees on deputation with the Central Government, (b) persons appointed on contract basis, and (c) persons re-employed after retirement, the concession is admissible only if the appropriate administrative authority certifies that the employee is likely to continue to serve under the Central Government for at least **two years** (for LTC to Home Town) and at least **four years** (for LTC to any place in India), reckoned from the date of joining the post under the Central Government.

(3) For officers appointed on contract, where the initial contract is for **one year** but is later extended, the **total duration of the contract** is taken into account for LTC.

(4) For persons re-employed immediately after retirement **without any break**, the re-employed service is treated as continuous with previous service for LTC purposes.

> **EXAM NOTE:** Illustration: if an officer availed the All-India concession for a block of four years before retirement and is re-employed without break, he cannot avail it again until the expiry of that particular four-year block.

Rule 3 — Scope

The Leave Travel Concession covers the **Government servant himself and his family**.

Rule 4 — Definitions

(a) "A place in India" — any place within the territory of India, whether on the mainland or overseas (e.g. islands).

(b) "Controlling Officer" — an officer declared as such under **SR 191**.

(c) "Disciplinary Authority" — same meaning as in the CCS (CCA) Rules, **1965**.

(d) "Family" means the Government servant's —

- **Spouse** (wife or husband) — only **one wife** is included; where a second marriage was performed with the specific permission of the Government, the second legally wedded wife is also included. The condition of dependency does **not** apply between husband and wife;

- **Two surviving unmarried children** (including step-children and legally adopted children) wholly dependent on the Government servant, irrespective of whether they reside with him or not;
- **Son** — until he attains **25 years** of age, or until marriage or until he starts earning, whichever is earlier (but see the 2025 clarification below);
- **Daughter** — no age limit; until marriage or until she starts earning, whichever is earlier;
- **Married daughters** who are divorced, abandoned or separated from their husbands, and **widowed daughters**, residing with and wholly dependent on the Government servant;
- **Parents and/or step-parents** wholly dependent on the Government servant, **whether residing with him or not**; and
- **Unmarried minor brothers** and **unmarried / divorced / abandoned / separated / widowed sisters** residing with and wholly dependent on the Government servant, provided their parents are either not alive or are themselves wholly dependent on the Government servant.

UPDATED: Per DoP&T FAQ OM F.No. 31011/07/2025-PP.A-IV dated **01.07.2025**: a son/daughter **above 25 years of age who is still unmarried and wholly dependent** on the Government employee is eligible for LTC. The FAQ also confirms that **parents-in-law, grandparents**, children of divorced/abandoned/separated/widowed sisters or daughters, and more than one wife are **NOT** covered in the definition of family.

VERIFIED: **Dependency criterion:** a family member is deemed **wholly dependent** only if his/her income from all sources (including pension and Dearness Relief) does not exceed the minimum family pension of **Rs. 9,000 per month plus Dearness Relief thereon** (7th CPC position; reiterated in DoP&T FAQ dated 01.07.2025). The dependency criterion is not applicable to the spouse.

Government Decisions

- **More than two children** are eligible only if (i) the Government servant already had more than two children **prior to 20.10.1997** (the date the small-family restriction came into force); (ii) the children were **born within one year** of the coming into force of the restriction (i.e. up to 20.10.1998); or (iii) the number exceeds two as a result of a second child-birth resulting in **multiple births** [Explanation 1 to Rule 4(d); DoP&T Guidelines on LTC, OM dated 03.09.2025].

- Children of divorced, abandoned, separated or widowed sisters are **not** included in the term "family".
- **Newly married husband of a female Government servant:** where a female Government servant proceeds to her home town on LTC and gets married there, LTC may also be allowed to her husband for the journey from the home town to the headquarters of the female Government servant.

(e) "Home Town" — the town, village or any other place declared as such by the Government servant and accepted by the Controlling Officer.

(f) "Shortest direct route" — same meaning as in **SR 30** and orders issued thereunder from time to time.

Rule 5 — Change of Home Town

(a) The home town once declared and accepted by the Controlling Officer is treated as **final**.

(b) In exceptional circumstances, the **Head of the Department** (or, if the Government servant is himself the Head of the Department, the **Administrative Ministry**) may authorise a change in the declaration — but such a change may be made only **once during the entire service** of the Government servant.

Criteria considered for change of home town

- Whether the declared place requires the Government servant's physical presence at intervals for discharging domestic and social obligations, and whether he has been visiting it frequently after entry into service;
- whether he owns residential property there, or is a member of a joint family having such property there;
- whether his near relations are resident in that place; and
- whether, prior to entry into Government service, he had been living there for some years.

Rule 6 — Declaration of Place of Visit (All India LTC)

(a) When the concession to visit any place in India is to be availed by a Government servant or any member of his family, the **intended place of visit must be declared in advance** to the Controlling Officer.

(b) The declared place of visit may be **changed before commencement of the journey** with the approval of the Controlling Officer. It may not be changed after commencement of the journey, except in exceptional circumstances where it is established that the request could not be made earlier owing to circumstances beyond the Government servant's control.

(c) Such post-facto relaxation may be made by the **Administrative Ministry/Department or the Head of the Department**, as the case may be.

Rule 7 — Admissibility of LTC

(a) The Government servant must have completed **one year's continuous service** on the date of the journey performed by him or his family, as the case may be.

(b) LTC is admissible during **any period of leave, including casual leave and special casual leave**.

(c) LTC is also admissible during **Child Care Leave, maternity leave, paternity leave, child adoption leave, study leave and leave preparatory to retirement (LPR)** — in the case of LPR, the return journey must be completed before the expiry of the leave.

(d) During **study leave**, LTC may be availed from the place of study, but the fare is restricted to the fare admissible from headquarters to the place of visit/home town, or the actual expenditure, whichever is less.

> **UPDATED:** **Leave is necessary.** LTC is **NOT admissible for journeys during weekend holidays without availing any leave** [DoP&T FAQ OM dated 01.07.2025 (Q.27) and Guidelines OM dated 03.09.2025]. However, when **only the family members** of the Government servant are travelling on LTC, **no leave is required** of the Government servant [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.26)]. Any earlier suggestion that journeys during weekends alone (without leave) are permitted is **incorrect**.

Government Decisions

(1) Reimbursement of the outward journey only is allowed when:

- a dependent son/daughter gets employment, or gets married after going to the home town, or remains there for prosecution of studies;

- the family, having performed the journey to the home town, has no intention of completing the return journey — provided the Government servant forgoes in writing the concession for the return journey if performed by the family at a subsequent date.

(2) Reimbursement of the return journey only is allowed when:

- a newly married wife comes from the home town to the headquarters station, or a wife who has been living at the home town for a long period did not avail LTC for the outward journey;
- a dependent son/daughter returns with the parents, or comes alone from the home town where he/she was prosecuting studies or living with grandparents;
- a child who was below 5 / 12 years of age at the time of the outward journey completes **5 / 12 years** of age at the time of the return journey — the **actual rail fare for the return journey** is reimbursed as per the ticket purchased (half or full, as opted for a child of 5 and under 12) [DoP&T OM No. 31011/3/2016-Estt.(A.IV) dated 29.04.2016]; and
- a child legally adopted by the Government servant while staying at the home town.

> **EXAM NOTE:** The above special-case entitlements apply equally to "LTC to anywhere in India".

(3) When both husband and wife are Government servants:

- they may declare **separate home towns**;
- each can claim LTC for his/her respective eligible family members (own parents/step-parents/minor brothers/sisters);
- the children may claim as members of the family of **any one parent** in a particular block; and
- the spouse who avails LTC as a member of the other spouse's family **cannot claim independently for self** in that block.

(4) Escort: LTC is allowed for an escort accompanying a single handicapped Government servant, subject to conditions.

(5) Suspension: a Government servant under suspension cannot avail LTC for self, but the **members of his family are entitled** to it [also FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.12)].

(6) A Government servant whose headquarters/place of posting and home town are the **same** is not eligible for Home Town LTC.

Rule 8 — Types of LTC

(a) **Home Town LTC** — admissible irrespective of the distance between the headquarters and the home town, **once in a block of two calendar years**, e.g. **2024-25, 2026-27, 2028-29** and so on.

(b) **All India LTC (any place in India)** — admissible irrespective of the distance of the place of visit from the headquarters, **once in a block of four calendar years**, e.g. **2022-2025, 2026-2029** and so on.

> **VERIFIED:** The **current four-year block is 2026–2029**, with two-year sub-blocks **2026-27 and 2028-29**. (The previous block was 2022–2025 with sub-blocks 2022-23 and 2024-25.) All India LTC availed is in lieu of, and adjusted against, the Home Town LTC available at the time of commencement of the journey.

(c) **Hometown-every-year option:** a Government servant (married or unmarried) whose family lives away from his headquarters at his home town may, in lieu of all concessions under the scheme (including All India LTC) otherwise admissible to him and his family, avail LTC **for himself alone, every year**, to visit the home town.

(d) Entitlement of Fresh Recruits

- **Fresh recruits** to the Central Government may be allowed to travel to their **home town with family on three occasions in a block of four years** and to **any place in India on the fourth occasion**.
- This facility is available **only for the first two blocks of four years** after joining Government service for the first time, and becomes eligible on **completion of one year of service**. Thus: occasions 1–3 — Home Town; 4th — All India; 5–7 — Home Town; 8th — All India [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.64)].
- After the eighth occasion (i.e. on expiry of the first two personal four-year blocks), the entitlement is regulated under the **regular block years** as per the usual LTC Rules.
- A fresh recruit whose headquarters and home town are the **same** cannot avail Home Town LTC; he may avail LTC to any place in India on the **4th and 8th occasions only**.

- **No carry-forward:** the annual LTC of a fresh recruit **lapses** if not availed in that year [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.67)].

Illustration (DoP&T): date of joining 30th September 2013 —

Year of LTC	Type	Occasion
30.09.2013 to 29.09.2014	Completion of first year — no LTC	—
30.09.2014 to 31.12.2014	Home Town	1st
01.01.2015 to 31.12.2015	Home Town	2nd
01.01.2016 to 31.12.2016	Home Town	3rd
01.01.2017 to 31.12.2017	Any place in India	4th
01.01.2018 to 31.12.2018	Home Town	5th
01.01.2019 to 31.12.2019	Home Town	6th
01.01.2020 to 31.12.2020	Home Town	7th
01.01.2021 to 31.12.2021	Any place in India	8th
From 01.01.2022	Regular LTC blocks apply	—

Rule 9 — Counting of LTC against Particular Blocks

(a) A Government servant and the members of his family may **travel in different groups at different times** during a block of two or four years, as the case may be.

(b) The concession is counted against the block within which the **outward journey commenced**, even if the return journey is performed after the expiry of the block. This applies equally to carried-forward LTC under Rule 10.

(c) In the same two-year sub-block, **some members of the family may avail Home Town LTC while others avail All India LTC** [also FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.7)].

Rule 10 — Carryover of LTC

(a) A Government servant who is unable to avail LTC within a particular block of two or four years may avail it within the **first year of the next block**.

(b) If a Government servant is entitled to Home Town LTC, he can carry forward the **All India LTC** for a block of four years only if he has carried forward the **Home Town LTC in respect of the second two-year sub-block** within that four-year block.

Example — current block 2026–2029 (grace periods):

- **1st sub-block 2026-27:** Home Town LTC of this sub-block may be availed (carried over) up to **31st December 2028**.
- **2nd sub-block 2028-29 / All India LTC of block 2026-29:** may be availed (carried over) up to **31st December 2030**.

Rule 11 — Place to be Visited under All India LTC

A Government servant and each member of his family may visit **different places of their own choice** during a block of four years. It is not necessary for the members of the family to visit the same place as that visited by the Government servant himself at any time earlier during the same block.

Rule 12 — Entitlement

For travel under the LTC scheme, the entitlements are as under with effect from **01.07.2017** [MoF (DoE) OM dated 13.07.2017 read with DoP&T OM No. 31011/8/2017-Estt.A-IV dated 19.09.2017]. **No daily allowance** is admissible for travel on LTC, and incidental expenses/local journeys are not reimbursable.

A(i). Travel entitlements within the country

Pay Level in Pay Matrix	Travel entitlement
14 and above	Business/Club class by air OR AC-I by train
12 and 13	Economy class by air OR AC-I by train
9 to 11	Economy class by air OR AC-II by train
6 to 8	AC-II by train (air travel allowed for TA on tour only — NOT for LTC)
5 and below	First Class / AC-III / AC Chair Car by train

> **EXAM NOTE:** For LTC, **air travel is admissible only to officials in Pay Level 9 and above**. Officials in Level 6 to 8 are entitled to air travel for TA (official tour) only, **not for LTC** [DoP&T OM dated 19.09.2017; FAQ dated 01.07.2025].

A(ii). Premium / premium Tatkal / Suvidha trains, Tatkal and flexi fare

- **Travel by Premium trains, Premium Tatkal trains and Suvidha trains is allowed on LTC.** Reimbursement of Tatkal and Premium Tatkal charges is also admissible [DoP&T OM dated 19.09.2017, w.e.f. 01.07.2017].

- **Flexi fare (dynamic fare)** applicable in **Rajdhani / Shatabdi / Duronto** trains is admissible for journeys performed by these trains on LTC. This dynamic-fare component is **not** admissible where a non-entitled Government servant travels by air and claims reimbursement for the entitled class of these trains — in such cases reimbursement is made after deducting the dynamic component [DoP&T OMs dated 17.04.2017 & 19.09.2017].
- **Catering charges** included compulsorily in the rail fare of Rajdhani/Shatabdi/Duronto trains are reimbursable in full as per entitlement.

UPDATED: By DoP&T OM No. 31011/3/2022-PP.A-IV dated **14.01.2025**, apart from the existing Rajdhani, Shatabdi and Duronto trains, travel by **Tejas Express, Vande Bharat Express and Humsafar Express** is also allowed under LTC, as per the following entitlement:

Pay Level in Pay Matrix	Shatabdi or similar type trains	Rajdhani type or similar type trains
Level 12 and above	Executive Class	AC 1st Class
Level 6 to 11	Chair Car	AC 2nd Class
Level 5 and below	Chair Car	AC 3rd Class

A(iii). Conditions attached to the revised entitlements

- For places **not connected by rail**: travel by AC bus is allowed for those entitled to AC-II and above by train, and by Deluxe/ordinary bus for others.
- For **road travel between places connected by rail**: travel by any means of public transport is allowed, provided the total fare does not exceed the train fare of the entitled class.
- In case of **non-availability of seats in the entitled class**, Government servants may travel in a class below their entitled class.

B. Overseas / international travel — position under LTC

UPDATED: Under **Rule 4(a)**, "a place in India" covers any place within the territory of India, whether on the mainland or overseas (e.g. island territories). LTC is availed to the **home town or to any place within India** — there is **no general 'international travel' entitlement** for leisure to a foreign country. The air-class slabs for foreign travel that appear in the 7th CPC Travelling Allowance structure (Level 17 — First; Level 14–16 — Business; Level 13 and below — Economy) govern

official foreign tours (TA); they do **not** operate as an LTC leisure entitlement, and the generic table has therefore been omitted from the LTC entitlement set.

The one situation in which an overseas journey is recognised under LTC is the following:

- **Home town situated outside India:** a Government servant who declares (subject to the satisfaction of the Controlling Officer) that his home town is **outside India** is **entitled to Home Town LTC to visit it** [DoP&T Guidelines on LTC, OM dated 03.09.2025]. Reimbursement is, however, restricted to the fare for the journey **up to and from the port/place of departure from India by the shortest route**; the cost of the sea/air passage **beyond Indian limits is not reimbursable**. Any restrictions on visits to border/restricted areas must be complied with.

C(i). Journeys by sea or river steamer (other than A&N and Lakshadweep)

Pay Level in Pay Matrix	Travel entitlement
9 and above	Highest class
6 to 8	Lower class, if there be two classes only on the steamer
4 and 5	If two classes only — the lower class; if three classes — the middle or second class; if four classes — the third class
3 and below	Lowest class

C(ii). Between the mainland and A&N / Lakshadweep islands (SCI ships)

Pay Level in Pay Matrix	Travel entitlement
9 and above	Deluxe class
6 to 8	First / 'A' Cabin class
4 and 5	Second / 'B' Cabin class
3 and below	Bunk class

UPDATED: The table above stands **corrected** as per MoF (DoE) OM No. 19030/1/2017-E.IV dated 13.07.2017: Levels 6–8 are entitled to **First/'A' Cabin class** (not Deluxe) and Levels 3 and below to **Bunk class** (not Second/'B' Cabin).

D(i). Mileage allowance for journeys by road — where specific rates are prescribed

Pay Level in Pay Matrix	Entitlement
14 and above	Actual fare by any type of public bus (including AC bus); OR at prescribed rates for AC taxi/own car (for journeys by AC taxi, taxi or own car); OR at prescribed rates for autorickshaw, own scooter/motorcycle, etc.
6 to 13	Same as above, except journeys by AC taxi
5 and below	Actual fare by ordinary public bus only; OR at prescribed rates for autorickshaw, own scooter/motorcycle, etc.

D(ii). Where no specific rates have been prescribed by the State Transport Directorate

Journey performed by	Rate w.e.f. 01.07.2017	Rate w.e.f. 01.01.2024
Own car / taxi	Rs. 24 per km	Rs. 30 per km
Autorickshaw, own scooter, etc.	Rs. 12 per km	Rs. 15 per km

VERIFIED: Under MoF (DoE) OM dated 13.07.2017, the mileage rates rise by **25% whenever DA increases by 50%**. DA reached 50% w.e.f. **01.01.2024** [DoE OM No. 1/1/2024-E-II(B) dated 12.03.2024]; the enhanced rates of Rs. 30 / Rs. 15 per km therefore apply from 01.01.2024 (arrears clarified, e.g., RBE No. 07/2025). The next 25% enhancement will be due only when DA rises by a further 50%.

Government Decisions — Booking of air tickets on LTC

[DoP&T OMs dated **29.08.2022, 10.08.2023 and 20.10.2023**; FAQ dated 01.07.2025]

- In all cases of air travel on LTC, tickets must be purchased **only from the three Authorised Travel Agents (ATAs)**: (i) M/s Balmer Lawrie & Company Limited; (ii) M/s Ashok Travels & Tours; and (iii) **IRCTC** (Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation). **No agency charges/convenience fees** are payable to the ATAs (the ATAs also do not charge cancellation fees on bookings made through them).
- Employees must choose the flight with the **Best Available (cheapest) Fare** in the entitled class — or a fare up to **10% higher** than the cheapest available within the same **three-hour window** — preferably a non-stop flight, and must retain a print-

out of the ATA webpage showing flight and fare details for settlement of the claim.

- Employees are **encouraged** to book tickets at least **21 days** prior to the intended date of travel (recommended, not compulsory) and to avoid unnecessary cancellations; a cancellation made less than **24 hours** before the intended travel requires a self-declared justification. Cancellation charges are reimbursed only where the cancellation was due to circumstances beyond the employee's control or official exigencies.
- Employees must register their **official Government e-mail ID** with the three ATAs for digital booking by any airline. For employees who do not have an official e-mail account, the administrative office sends the employee's details (name, code, personal e-mail, mobile) to the ATAs for registration [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.46)].
- In unavoidable circumstances where the ticket is booked through an unauthorised travel agent/website, the **Financial Adviser** of the Ministry/Department (or HoD of Joint Secretary level for attached/subordinate offices) may grant relaxation.

UPDATED: LTC-80 discontinued: the Air India 'LTC-80' fare scheme is **no longer applicable**, since Air India is no longer a Government PSU [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.48)]. Travel by **helicopter** is not allowed on LTC (Q.50), and **break-journey by air** is not allowed except for connecting flights/scheduled layovers (Q.52).

Provisions for advances (air travel)

- Employees entitled to air travel may apply for LTC advance with the print-out of the ATA webpage showing suitable flight and fare details, at least **30 days** prior to the intended date of journey [OM dated 29.08.2022].
- Employees not entitled to air travel who wish to fly (otherwise than under the Special Dispensation Scheme) may apply for LTC advance with reference to their entitled **rail/bus fare**.
- Non-entitled employees travelling under the **Special Dispensation Scheme** may apply for advance with reference to rail/bus fare from headquarters up to the notified rail-head **plus** the air fare from the rail-head to the place of visit, as under:

Headquarters / place of posting to —	Notified rail-head	Place of visit
(by entitled rail/bus fare)	Kolkata or Guwahati	Any place in the North East Region
(by entitled rail/bus fare)	Kolkata / Chennai / Visakhapatnam	Port Blair (A&N)
(by entitled rail/bus fare)	Delhi / Amritsar	Any place in J&K / Ladakh

Provisions for reimbursement (air travel)

- If, at the time of actual booking after receipt of the advance, there is a difference in fare owing to the time gap, the difference is adjusted at the time of settlement of the claim.
- Where a non-entitled employee under the Special Dispensation Scheme flies **directly** from headquarters to the place of visit, he must retain the print-out of flight and fare details of the flight in the **same time-slot** (or, if unavailable, the next slot); reimbursement is restricted to the actual air fare for the direct journey or the fare entitled under the Scheme, **whichever is less**.
- Non-entitled employees flying **outside** the Special Dispensation Scheme are not required to book through the ATAs; reimbursement is restricted to the actual air fare or the entitled train/bus fare by the shortest route, **whichever is less**.

Special Dispensation Scheme — NER, J&K, Ladakh and A&N

VERIFIED: Extended for a further period of two years, **w.e.f. 26.09.2024 till 25.09.2026** [DoP&T OM No. 31011/15/2022-Estt.A-IV dated 17.09.2024]. The LTC journey may validly **commence up to 25.09.2026** [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.56)]. **Sikkim is included in the NER**; the **Lakshadweep Islands are NOT covered** by the Scheme (Q.57–58). As on June 2026 no further extension has been notified; aspirants should watch for orders near 25.09.2026.

- All eligible Government servants may avail LTC to visit any place in **NER / A&N / J&K / Ladakh** against the **conversion of one Home Town LTC** in a four-year block.
- Government servants whose home town and headquarters/place of posting are the **same** are not allowed the conversion (they are not eligible for Home Town LTC); they may, however, use their **All India LTC** for these regions.

- A Government servant whose **home town is situated in** NER/A&N/J&K/Ladakh is allowed conversion of Home Town LTC to visit any place in any one of the other three regions (i.e. excluding the region of his home town).
- **Fresh recruits** are allowed conversion of **one of the three Home Town LTCs** in a block of four years to visit NER/A&N/J&K/Ladakh; in addition, they are allowed **one additional conversion** of Home Town LTC to visit the **UT of J&K / UT of Ladakh** in a block of four years.
- **Non-air-entitled** Government servants are allowed to travel by air in **Economy class by any airline**: (i) between Kolkata/Guwahati and any place in the NER; (ii) between Kolkata/Chennai/Visakhapatnam and Port Blair; (iii) between Delhi/Amritsar and any place in J&K/Ladakh — and also **directly from headquarters** to these regions, subject to the reimbursement conditions of OM dated 29.08.2022.
- An employee may benefit **twice in a block** for these regions — once by conversion of Home Town LTC and once using the All India LTC [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.62–63)].

Rule 13 — Reimbursement

Reimbursement under the LTC scheme **does not cover incidental expenses or expenditure on local journeys**. Reimbursement is allowed only on the basis of a **point-to-point journey on a through ticket over the shortest direct route**.

Government Decisions

- **Journey by longer route in two classes:** when a longer (non-cheapest) route is used in two different classes of rail accommodation, the entitled-class rate is admissible for the corresponding proportion of the shortest/cheapest route, and the lower-class rate for the remaining mileage.
- **E-ticket booking charges** for rail journeys booked through IRCTC are reimbursable; so are taxes/levies such as service tax/GST and education cess on travel.
- **Catering charges** are admissible for rail journeys on LTC where the catering facility is compulsorily included in the fare.
- **Tejas Express / Vande Bharat Express / Humsafar Express** trains are allowed for LTC (and for tour/training/transfer/retirement journeys) [OM dated 14.01.2025].

- **Tour packages:** package tours are not reimbursable, except those conducted by **IRCTC, ITDC or State Tourism Development Corporations**, limited to the fare component only, with a fare certificate [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.36, Q.44)].
- **Taxi/auto fare between residence and airport/railway station is NOT reimbursable** (it is a local journey) [FAQ (Q.38)].
- **Circular trip / concessional circular tour tickets:** reimbursement is restricted to the fare by the shortest direct route from headquarters to the declared destination [FAQ (Q.39–40)].
- **Places not connected by public transport:** reimbursement as per entitlement for a maximum of **200 km in all (100 km each way)** covered by private/personal transport, based on self-certification [FAQ (Q.31)].
- **Disability:** travel by own/hired vehicle is allowed for a Government servant with a disability, on production of a medical certificate and self-declaration, with reimbursement capped at the entitled class fare [FAQ (Q.30)].

Child fare — train

Age of child	Fare	Remarks
Under 5 years	Nil	Without separate berth/seat. If a separate berth/seat is opted for a child below 5, the fare paid is NOT reimbursable [FAQ (Q.10)]
5 years and under 12 years	Half adult fare	If separate berth/seat is not sought
5 years and under 12 years	Full adult fare	If separate berth/seat is sought (actual fare as per the ticket option is reimbursed)

Child fare — air

- Up to 2 years (24 months): normally **10% of adult fare** plus taxes (lap infant).
- Above 2 years: full fare equal to the adult fare. (A non-air-entitled employee cannot claim air fare charged for a child below 5 years, except where allowed under the Special Dispensation Scheme.)

Time limits for processing LTC applications

S.No.	Course of action	Time limit
1	Leave sanction	5 working days + 3 working days*
2	Sanction of LTC advance / leave encashment	5 working days + 3 working days*
3	Verification of LTC claim by Administration after submission of the LTC bill	10 working days + 3 working days*
4	Time taken by DDO	5 working days + 3 working days*
5	Time taken by PAO	5 working days + 3 working days*

** Additional 3 days of transit time may be allowed where the place of posting of the Government servant is away from the headquarters.*

Rule 14 — Forfeiture of Claim

A claim for reimbursement shall be submitted within **three months** after completion of the return journey, **if no advance had been drawn**. Failure to do so entails **forfeiture** of the claim, and no relaxation in this regard is permissible under the rule itself.

Government Decisions

- **Time limits for submission of claims:** (a) if advance is drawn — within **one month** of completion of the return journey; (b) if no advance is drawn — within **three months**.
- **Relaxation** of these time limits is delegated to the Ministry/Department (with the concurrence of the Financial Adviser), and to attached/subordinate offices (with the concurrence of an HoD not below the rank of Joint Secretary), without reference to DoP&T, where the Government servant could not submit the claim in time owing to circumstances beyond his control [DoP&T OM F.No. 31011/18/2023-Estt.(A-IV) dated 21.12.2023, in supersession of OM dated 27.09.2007]: (a) where **no advance** was drawn — the LTC bill may be submitted within a period not exceeding **six months**; (b) where an **advance** was drawn — the claim may be submitted within **three months** of completion of the return journey, provided the Government employee refunds the **entire amount of advance** (not merely the unutilised portion) with **penal interest on the entire amount, in one lump sum, from the date of drawal to the date of recovery**.

UPDATED: The earlier condition under OM dated 27.09.2007 — refund of the advance within **45 days** of the return journey — stands **superseded**. Under the OM dated 21.12.2023 (reiterated in the DoP&T FAQ dated 01.07.2025, Q.35 & Q.71), the operative condition for the three-month relaxation is refund of the **entire** advance, in **one lump sum**, with **penal interest on the entire amount from the date of drawal to the date of recovery** — there is no separate 45-day refund window.

Rule 15 — Grant of Advance and Adjustment

- Advance may be granted up to **90% of the estimated fare** for the journey both ways [Government decision; the text of Rule 15 itself prescribes four-fifths, but the operative position followed is 90% of the fare]. Advance is admissible for both the outward and return journeys if the leave taken (or the anticipated absence of family members) does not exceed **90 days**; otherwise, advance may be drawn for the outward journey only.
- If the family travels separately from the Government servant, the **advance may also be drawn separately** to the extent admissible.
- The advance must be **refunded in full** if the outward journey is not commenced within **65 days** of the grant of advance (journeys by air/sea/road).
- For journeys **by train**, advance may be drawn up to **125 days** (i.e. 4 months and 5 days) before the proposed date of the journey [DoP&T OM dated 13.05.2016]. In **all** cases of advance, the Government servant must produce the **outward journey tickets** to the competent authority within **10 days of the drawal** of the advance.
- Where an advance has been drawn, the claim must be submitted within **one month** of completion of the return journey; failing this, the **entire advance is refundable forthwith in one lump sum** — no recovery in instalments is entertained.

FLAG / UNCERTAINTY: The 125-day window for train journeys was fixed when the Railways' Advance Reservation Period (ARP) was 120 days. The ARP was reduced to **60 days w.e.f. 01.11.2024** (Ministry of Railways), but as on June 2026 **no DoP&T OM revising the 125-day limit has been traced**. For examination purposes, quote **125 days** as per the OM dated 13.05.2016 in force.

Government Decision

- **Penal interest** is chargeable at **2% above the GPF interest rate**. Where the relaxation under the OM dated 21.12.2023 is invoked, penal interest is levied on the **entire amount of advance** from the date of drawal to the date of recovery.

Leave Encashment with LTC (Rule 38-A, CCS (Leave) Rules, 1972)

- Encashment of Earned Leave up to **10 days** at a time is permissible while availing LTC, subject to a maximum of **60 days during the entire career**; a balance of at least **30 days EL** must remain after the encashment. Such encashment is **not deducted** from the quantum of leave encashable at retirement.
- Encashment is allowed **once in a sub-block/block year** even where the Government servant himself does not travel but his family avails LTC; it is also admissible where the journey is performed by private/hired vehicle with a 'Nil' fare claim — subject to advance intimation, sanction of leave and self-declaration of the journey [FAQ dated 01.07.2025 (Q.21–23)].
- Where **both husband and wife** are Government servants, both may avail leave encashment with LTC [FAQ (Q.24)].
- The spouse of a Government employee working in the **Railways** may be allowed encashment of leave up to **10 days** on the All India LTC availed by the Government employee.
- A **re-employed pensioner** entitled to LTC may encash EL during re-employment up to the overall limit of **60 days** (including encashment availed with LTC while in service).

Rule 16 — Fraudulent Claim of LTC

(1) If the Disciplinary Authority decides to initiate disciplinary proceedings against a Government servant on the charge of preferring a **fraudulent LTC claim**, he shall **not be allowed LTC till the finalisation** of such proceedings.

(2) If the proceedings result in the imposition of any penalty specified in **Rule 11 of the CCS (CCA) Rules, 1965**, the Government servant shall not be allowed the **next two sets** of LTC, in addition to the sets already withheld during the pendency of the proceedings. For reasons recorded in writing, the Controlling Authority may disallow **more than two sets**.

(3) If the Government servant is **fully exonerated**, he shall be allowed to avail the withheld concession(s) as **additional set(s) in future block years, before the normal date of his superannuation**.

Dak Sutra — One-Page Quick Revision

Point	Position (in force, 2026)
Rules commenced	21.05.1988
Eligibility	1 year continuous service on the date of journey
Home Town LTC	Once in 2-yr block (2026-27, 2028-29); self-alone every year option if family at home town
All India LTC	Once in 4-yr block (current: 2026–2029)
Carryover	Within the first year of the next block
Fresh recruits	8 LTCs in first 8 years (HT×3 + AI on 4th; HT×3 + AI on 8th); no carry-forward
Dependency limit	Income ≤ Rs. 9,000 p.m. + DR thereon (not applicable to spouse)
Change of home town	Only once in entire service (HoD / Administrative Ministry)
Leave needed?	Yes — any leave incl. CL/SCL/CCL; NOT weekends alone; no leave needed if only family travels
Air on LTC	Level 9 & above only; 3 ATAs; cheapest fare or ≤10% band in 3-hr window; LTC-80 discontinued
Premium trains	Rajdhani/Shatabdi/Duronto + Tejas/Vande Bharat/Humsafar (OM 14.01.2025); flexi fare & tatkal admissible
Road mileage (no prescribed rates)	Rs. 30/km own car-taxi; Rs. 15/km auto/scooter (w.e.f. 01.01.2024)
SDS (NER/J&K/Ladakh/A&N)	26.09.2024 to 25.09.2026; conversion of 1 Home Town LTC; economy air for non-entitled
Claim limits	1 month (advance drawn) / 3 months (no advance); relaxation up to 3 months (advance — full advance returned in 3 months, lump sum + interest) / 6 months (no advance), with FA concurrence [OM 21.12.2023]
Advance	90% of fare; train 125 days, air/sea/road 65 days; tickets within 10 days of drawal
Penal interest	2% above GPF rate; on entire advance from drawal to recovery where relaxation invoked
Fraudulent claim	Next 2 sets disallowed (more, for recorded reasons); restored as additional sets if exonerated